

Even if you were to look at say the Times of India – on organization that summarises the news from the world over – it still doesn't have enough news to make you spend more than a few minutes a day on it.

These “news” channels do provide us with real news sometimes, but the bulk of the content they create is for entertainment. And who are we kidding, you probably learnt more from the Big Bang Theory and John Oliver's rants than you did from any news channel!

Our style of consumption has changed. Apps rule the roost and social media is now a better source of news than anything else on the planet. Earthquake in Iceland? You heard it first on twitter. A meteorite smashes into Russia, Twitter told you that and YouTube showed you the footage. Maybe you didn't even turn on your TV.

connected network of humans and news spreads faster than it's ever spread before and the TV had absolutely nothing to do with it. Zilch. Nada.

Live sports are a different matter altogether. As we've mentioned earlier, broadcasting a sporting event is an extremely lucrative proposition, something that neither the broadcaster nor the cable operator wants to lose out on. Still, it wouldn't be stretching the truth in the slightest to assume that the bulk of us would rather just have access to our sports anywhere and everywhere than just on the TV in the living room. One might argue that watching sports is a communal event, but what can be more communal than the internet? And anyway, it's not like you can't stream to a TV just as easily as from cable/DTH. Even if you were to look at the costs, we're pretty sure that you'd rather

to watch our favourite programs without breaking the Internet, using a protocol that the engineers say wasn't designed specifically for video. Where do we watch that content? On our phones, on our laptops, on our PCs and on our tablets.

BBC's iPlayer

Where there's a will there's a way and there's obviously no will here, at least on the part of the cable companies and content creators. Or rather, there is a will, but maybe it's working towards the wrong goals because the issue has already been sorted out by the BBC more than five years ago.

When you're already paying upwards of ₹14,600 a year for access to broadcast TV, you'd be well within your rights to expect your money's worth, especially if you really don't have any other option. But what if that TV network actually listened to you and understood your needs? What if that TV network decided that it was high time that it embraced the digital world and realised that the television is not the primary consumption device anymore?

Well, if that's you, then you're living in the UK and the network in question is the BBC. Six million pounds later, they came out with the iPlayer. What is it? In a nutshell, it's an app for Mac, Linux, Windows, iOS and Android that allows anyone with a UK IP address to stream all of the BBC's programs anytime, anywhere. It's as convenient and as simple as that.

You're still getting access all the content on your TV, but you're also getting access to it anywhere and with the right hardware, streaming to your TV from your device is a cinch. It's still not a properly “smart” app the way Netflix or Amazon Instant Video apps are (it doesn't learn your preferences for example), but as a TV alternative, it's hard to beat, especially when you have a line-up as amazing as the one hosted by the BBC.

YouTube

TV was a form of entertainment par excellence in its heydays. It was an all-encompassing entity that provided you with music, movies, news, fun, advice and catered to just about every niche possible, but it never anticipated YouTube.

There are no words to describe something like YouTube, neither its scope nor



Much like stealing water or tapping high-tension wires, we've found a way to steal content

When did you really look at the news seriously, for the sake of knowledge or being “well aware of current events”? The only reason you'd really turn to a news channel is because someone told you that there's something you have to see (unless of course, you never miss an episode involving Arnab Goswami and gang indulging in shouting matches – which can be both entertaining and informative).

We spend a ludicrous amount of time staring at some sort of screen or the other, be it a mobile phone, tablet or PC (and maybe the Smart Watch in the near future). We're already a vast and inter-

be paying ₹300 a month (via the internet) to comfortably access your favourite sport at your leisure than to remain at the mercy of a location and a single device.

Where there's a will, there's always a way

For many of us, especially in a country like India (that doesn't have access to reliable digital streaming services like Netflix), torrents are a way of life and EZTV our TV Guide. We schedule our torrents to coincide with our “night unlimited” packs, link up µTorrent with RSS feeds from TPB and so much more. We basically found a way